Who Helps Our Community?

A little book about a big ballot

The jobs. The people. The choices.

Wake County, North Carolina / November 3, 2026

Ballot B0037 / Read together. Ask questions. Make room for different ideas.

Hello, neighbor!

I'm Pip, your acorn guide. Let's explore!

A ballot is a list of choices.

Eligible adults use it to choose leaders and answer public questions. You can learn about those choices before you are old enough to vote.

We share a place.

Some children learn at school. Some learn at home. We all have neighbors, drink water, and need safe places to live.

We can wonder together.

Ask what a job can do, what each person says, and what evidence we have. People can disagree and still listen kindly.

FOR YOUR READING TEAM

Read one spread at a time. A spread is two pages facing each other.

Open the book. Follow a job.

The left page tells you about the work.
The right page introduces the choices.

Our country: Senate and House	**4-7**
Our state's highest court	**8-9**
Three Court of Appeals choices	**10-15**
Our state's lawmakers	**16-19**
Local judge and district attorney	**20-23**
County leaders, clerk, and sheriff	**24-29**
Soil and water supervisors	**30-31**
Five questions for voters	**32-36**
Your turn to wonder	**37**
Grown-up notes and sources	**38 onward**

A few helpful words
Candidate: a person asking for a job.
Party: a group that works together in politics.
Nonpartisan: no party label on that part of the ballot.
Budget: a plan for shared money.

U.S. Senate

Our country is big! Each state sends two senators to Washington, D.C. They speak for people across their state.

Senators vote on national laws and how to spend shared money. They also vote on many people the president picks for important jobs, including judges.

Their choices can affect doctor bills, food help, clean air, and war. One senator needs other people to agree before a plan can become law.

A term is how long the job lasts: 6 years.

LET'S WONDER

If you could ask a senator to help with one problem, what would it be?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 03. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

U.S. Senate

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Michael Dublin
Green

Retired teacher, veteran, and community volunteer.

Says: Spend less on the military and more on health care, housing, and food help.

Sources 09, 10

Roy Cooper
Democratic

Former North Carolina governor and attorney general.

Says: Lower family and health-care costs, and protect benefits for older people.

Sources 02, 10

Shannon W. Bray
Libertarian

Navy veteran who works with computers and security.

Says: Make government spending easier to check, and protect people from unfair computer surveillance.

Sources 10

Michael Whatley
Republican

Lawyer and former national Republican Party chair.

Says: Support President Trump's plans, tighten border enforcement, and reduce government spending.

Sources 02, 11

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

U.S. House of Representatives

Imagine our country divided into many neighborhoods called districts. Each district chooses one person for the U.S. House.

Our choice is for District 2. A representative helps write national laws, votes on shared money, and asks government leaders to explain their work.

These choices can affect homes, roads, doctor visits, and jobs. The House and Senate usually must agree on a law, then send it to the president.

A term is how long the job lasts: 2 years.

LET'S WONDER

What would you tell a representative about the place where you live?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 04. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

U.S. House / District 2

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Eugene F. Douglass

Republican

Retired chemistry teacher and consultant.

Says: Use more nuclear power, reduce federal spending, and make Congress check the president.

Sources 02, 12

Deborah K. Ross

Democratic

Our current representative; a lawyer and former state lawmaker.

Says: Bring more federal help for affordable homes, transportation, and education.

Grown-up record note: financial reporting, page 39.

Sources 12, 13

Matthew Laszacs

Libertarian

Business leader who manages how organizations work.

Says: Make Congress do more oversight, reduce unnecessary rules, and let voters rank candidates.

Sources 12

The official ballot also has 1 write-in line. A write-in is a place for another eligible candidate's name.

North Carolina Supreme Court

Sometimes people disagree about what a law means. North Carolina's highest court helps answer important legal questions.

Seven justices work together. They review cases and explain how the law and our state Constitution apply. The Constitution is our state's big rulebook.

Their decisions can affect voting, rights, and fair treatment. They must listen carefully and decide by the law, even when a powerful person wants something else.

A term is how long the job lasts: 8 years.

LET'S WONDER

What helps a person be fair when two people tell different stories?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05, 06. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC Supreme Court / Seat 1

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Anita Earls

Democratic

Already serves on this court; worked as a civil-rights lawyer.

Says: Keep courts independent and protect everyone's rights.

Grown-up record note: a complaint was dismissed, page 39.

Sources 02, 06

Sarah Stevens

Republican

Longtime lawyer and state lawmaker; has not been a judge.

Says: Apply the written law and Constitution strictly and neutrally.

Grown-up record note: campaign donations, page 39.

Sources 02, 06

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

Court of Appeals Seat 1

A court has finished a case. But someone thinks the court used the law the wrong way. What happens next?

An appeal asks another court to check for legal mistakes. Usually, three Court of Appeals judges work together. They read the case record and hear legal arguments.

They do not start the whole trial over. Their checks help protect fair treatment. Seat 1 is one of three separate appeals-court jobs on this ballot.

A term is how long the job lasts: 8 years.

LET'S WONDER

Why might it help to have more than one careful person check a decision?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05, 06. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC Court of Appeals / Seat 1

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Michael C. Byrne

Republican

Judge in a court that hears disputes involving state agencies.

Says: Treat people fairly and get the law right.

Sources 02, 06

John S. Arrowood

Democratic

Already serves on the Court of Appeals.

Says: Keep courts independent and protect equal justice and rights.

Sources 02, 06

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

Court of Appeals Seat 2

Here is another seat on the same Court of Appeals. It is a separate choice, with two different candidates.

Imagine a trial where an important legal rule was skipped. Appeals judges read what happened and decide whether that mistake needs to be fixed.

Their work can change what happens to a family, a business, or a person accused of a crime. Judges must check the law rather than choose a favorite side.

A term is how long the job lasts: 8 years.

LET'S WONDER

Can someone care about safety and still insist on fair rules for everyone?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05, 06. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC Court of Appeals / Seat 2

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

George Cooper Bell

Republican

Superior Court judge with experience in criminal cases.

Says: Apply the law without bias and emphasize community safety.

Grown-up record note: formal lawyer discipline, page 39.

Sources 02, 06

Tobias (Toby) Hampson

Democratic

Already serves on the Court of Appeals; worked on appeals as a lawyer.

Says: Protect rights and keep party politics from controlling courts.

Sources 02, 06

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

Court of Appeals Seat 3

This is the third appeals-court choice. The judges have the same kind of job, but these candidates bring different experience.

An appeals judge must read closely, listen, and explain a decision. Sometimes the judges agree. Sometimes a judge writes why they disagree.

Clear explanations help people understand their rights and the rules. An appeals judge cannot promise to make a friend win a future case.

A term is how long the job lasts: 8 years.

LET'S WONDER

When you disagree, how can you explain your reasons kindly and clearly?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05, 06. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC Court of Appeals / Seat 3

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Craig Collins

Republican

Has been a prosecutor, lawyer, and judge in two trial courts.

Says: Follow the Constitution and avoid making new laws as a judge.

Sources 02, 06

Christine Marie Walczyk

Democratic

Wake County District Court judge since 2007.

Says: Protect rights and help people have equal access to court.

Sources 02, 06

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

North Carolina State Senate

North Carolina has its own lawmakers in Raleigh. They make rules for our state. The State Senate is one of two groups that do this work.

Our district chooses one senator. Senators vote on state laws and a budget: a plan for spending shared money.

Their choices can affect teachers, roads, taxes, and health care. Even when you learn at home, these decisions affect your neighbors and your community. The State House has a say, too.

A term is how long the job lasts: 2 years.

LET'S WONDER

What is one thing our state should help people do well?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 07. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC State Senate / District 18

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Haseeb Fatmi

Democratic

Current state senator, lawyer, and former Wake Forest commissioner.

Says: Lower living costs, fund public schools, and make health care more affordable.

Sources 02, 14

Chris Stock

Republican

Lawyer who has worked for state lawmakers.

Says: Limit property-tax increases, raise teacher pay, and protect farmland.

Sources 02, 15

Brad Hessel

Libertarian

Technology consultant and business founder.

Says: Give families more education choices, lower health-care costs, and change election rules.

Sources 02, 16

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

North Carolina State House

The State House is the other group of North Carolina lawmakers. It is different from the U.S. House in Washington, D.C.

Our choice is for District 35. This person helps write state laws and decide how state money is used.

The State House and State Senate must work through disagreements. Their decisions can affect power bills, safe roads, public schools, and choices available to families. A single member cannot make every promise happen alone.

A term is how long the job lasts: 2 years.

LET'S WONDER

If two groups both have to agree, what could help them solve a problem?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 07. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC House / District 35

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Mike Schietzelt

Republican

Current state representative, lawyer, and Marine veteran.

Says: Lower living costs, improve roads, raise teacher pay, and support public safety.

Sources 02, 17

Evonne S. Hopkins

Democratic

Family-law lawyer and small-business owner.

Says: Lower costs, strengthen public schools, and make communities safer.

Sources 02, 18

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

District Court Judge

Some judges work close to home. District Court judges hear many kinds of cases, including family disagreements, cases involving children, and less serious crimes.

They listen to evidence: information that helps show what happened. They apply the law and make decisions in the cases they hear.

Their work can affect where a child lives and how a family gets help. A person accused of doing something wrong still has rights. A judge must be fair to every side.

A term is how long the job lasts: 4 years.

LET'S WONDER

Why should a judge hear the evidence before making up their mind?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

NC District Court / District 10A, Seat 1

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Rashad A. Hauter

Republican

Current District Court judge; previously worked as a prosecutor and other kinds of lawyer.

Says: Keep courts independent, open, and honest about their work.

Sources 02, 19

One printed name. This is called unopposed. There is no other printed candidate and no write-in line for this contest on B0037. You may leave a contest blank.

District Attorney

When a crime may have happened, the district attorney leads the lawyers who bring criminal cases for the state.

These lawyers decide which cases to bring and what evidence to show. They also help set priorities: which problems need the most attention.

The job affects safety, victims, and people accused of crimes. Sometimes treatment can help stop another offense. The district attorney does not run the jail, and does not decide guilt alone.

A term is how long the job lasts: 4 years.

LET'S WONDER

How could a community help someone stop making harmful choices?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

District Attorney / District 10

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Wiley Nickel

Democratic

Lawyer, former state senator, and former member of the U.S. House.

Says: Focus on violent crime and theft, support victims, and use treatment programs for some nonviolent cases.

Sources 02, 20

One printed name. This is called unopposed. There is no other printed candidate and no write-in line for this contest on B0037. You may leave a contest blank.

County Commissioners

A county is a group of communities. Wake County has leaders called commissioners. They work together on a board.

They set the county budget and property-tax rate. Their decisions help pay for libraries, emergency medical help, public schools, and other services.

At-large means these seats represent the whole county. Voters may choose up to two people. Commissioners help fund public schools; the school board runs the school system. Your homeschool is part of a wider community, too!

2026 terms: most votes = 4 years; second-most = 2 years.

LET'S WONDER

If there is money for only two improvements, how would you decide what comes first?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 46. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

Wake County Commissioners / At-Large

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 2 PEOPLE

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Kyle Stogoski

Republican

Works in pet-hospital services; has managed a political campaign.

Says: Keep living costs manageable, protect open land, and check how tax money is spent.

Sources 02, 21

Mona Singh

Democratic

Technology consultant and first-time candidate.

Says: Support public schools, affordable homes, and better ways to get around.

Sources 02, 22

Christine Kushner

Democratic

Former school-board chair with health-services board experience.

Says: Support schools, mental-health services, and stable, affordable housing.

Sources 02, 23

Gary Dale Hartong

Republican

Engineer and leader of a civil and environmental engineering company.

Says: Improve water and other public systems, modernize schools, and support businesses.

Sources 02, 24

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

Clerk of Superior Court

A courthouse needs careful record keepers. The clerk leads the office that keeps court papers and handles court money.

In North Carolina, the clerk also acts as a judge in some special matters. These include decisions about wills and what happens to property after someone dies.

Accurate papers and clear directions matter when families are already having a hard time. Good service can mean fewer delays and less confusion. This job is more than keeping a tidy desk.

A term is how long the job lasts: 4 years.

LET'S WONDER

How would you help someone who is worried and cannot find the right paper?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 05. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

Wake County Clerk of Superior Court

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Claudia C. Croom

Democratic

Current clerk; worked as a lawyer and a magistrate, a kind of court official.

Says: Hire and train staff, improve work routines, and help the office serve people better.

Sources 02, 25

Joe E. Teague, Jr.

Republican

Engineer and manager, according to his campaign.

Says: Find delays, improve office systems, measure results, and treat people respectfully.

Sources 02, 26

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

Sheriff

The sheriff leads a team of deputies and other workers. The team helps enforce laws, deliver court orders, and keep people safe.

The sheriff also runs the county jail. People in jail must have safe conditions and needed care, including people waiting for a trial.

This job affects emergency help, public trust, and how people are treated. The sheriff does not make every law or lead every town's police department. Safety and fair treatment both matter.

A term is how long the job lasts: 4 years.

LET'S WONDER

What would help people trust the people whose job is to keep them safe?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

Wake County Sheriff

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 1 PERSON

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

Kenny Blackwell

Republican

Former deputy, U.S. Marshal, and State Capitol Police investigator.

Says: Respond faster, expand mental-health help, and improve staff pay and community relationships.

Grown-up record note: residency questions and his response, page 40.

Sources 02, 27

Willie Rowe

Democratic

Current sheriff, with many years in the sheriff's office.

Says: Prevent crime, build public trust, and recruit and train enough staff.

Grown-up record note: jail safety failures and the response, page 40.

Sources 02, 28

A plan is a promise about what someone hopes to do. It is not a guarantee. Ask: How would it work? Who would it help? What would it cost?

Soil & Water Supervisors

Follow a raindrop! It lands on the ground, runs into a stream, and may reach water that people drink.

Soil and water supervisors help guide programs that protect land and water. They support farmers, teach neighbors, and help connect people with conservation tools and funding.

Healthy soil grows food. Cleaner streams help people, fish, and other animals. These supervisors do not control all building projects or run the water company. Voters may choose up to two people.

A term is how long the job lasts: 4 years.

LET'S WONDER

Where does rain go after it lands near your home?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02, 08. See the back of the book.

Meet the candidates

Wake Soil & Water Conservation District

VOTERS MAY CHOOSE UP TO 2 PEOPLE

Names follow official ballot order. "Says" means a stated aim.

NONPARTISAN: no party labels in this contest. Two write-in lines are also on the ballot.

Beth Pugh Farrell

Sources 02, 29

Current supervisor, farmer, and farm-program coordinator. Says: More help for farms, healthy soil, and stormwater problems.

Jim White

Sources 02, 30

Technology and food-supply business leader. Says: Keep farms viable and use practical partnerships for conservation.

Terence Thomas

Sources 02, 31

Real-estate and community consultant. Says: Protect farmland, conserve water, and study the effects of growth.

Brian K. Lewis

Sources 02, 32

Farm and compost worker; reports past conservation-board service. Says: Help farmers and homeowners protect soil and water.

Samantha Krop

Sources 02, 33

Riverkeeper who works to protect watersheds. Says: Protect drinking water, restore natural areas, and help flood-prone communities.

Cece Grant

Sources 02, 34

Environmental advocate with government-policy experience. Says: Support healthy farms, reduce pollution, and address climate change.

A picture ID for voting

Photo ID constitutional amendment

An ID is a card that helps show who someone is. Some IDs have a photo.

North Carolina's Constitution already talks about photo IDs for voting in person. This question would extend that wording to every way of voting, including mail.

FOR: Put that wider photo-ID rule into the Constitution.

AGAINST: Keep the Constitution's current wording.

Today's laws already ask for photo ID in person and a copy with mail ballots, with exceptions. This vote does not erase those existing laws or the power to allow exceptions.

TALK ABOUT THE TRADEOFF

How can a voting rule check who someone is and still help eligible people vote?

Grown-up sources: 01, 35, 36. See the back of the book.

A ceiling on income tax

3.5% income-tax cap constitutional amendment

Income is money people earn. Income tax sends some of it to the state to help pay for shared needs.

Think of a ceiling above a room. This question would lower the highest income-tax rate lawmakers are allowed to set, from 7% to 3.5%.

FOR: Set the lower ceiling of 3.5%, beginning with 2027 tax years.

AGAINST: Keep the ceiling at 7%.

A lower ceiling limits future tax increases, so families may keep more money than under a future higher rate. It also gives lawmakers less room to raise money for services. The ceiling is not everyone's actual tax rate.

TALK ABOUT THE TRADEOFF

How do we balance money for a family with money for things we share?

Grown-up sources: 01, 37. See the back of the book.

Limits on property taxes

Property-tax limits constitutional amendment

Property tax is money paid on things such as land and homes. Local governments use it to help pay for schools and other services.

This question would tell state lawmakers to make laws limiting how much local property-tax collections may grow.

FOR: Require lawmakers to create limits. They could allow exceptions.

AGAINST: Leave out that new requirement. Lawmakers could still make limits by ordinary law.

Limits could make costs more predictable for property owners. They could also leave less money for growing services. This amendment gives no exact limit and promises no smaller bill for a particular home.

TALK ABOUT THE TRADEOFF

If more neighbors need the same service, what happens when its budget cannot grow much?

Grown-up sources: 01, 38. See the back of the book.

Building places for children to learn

Wake County School Bonds

A bond lets a government borrow money now and pay it back over time. Interest is the extra money paid for borrowing.

This question asks about borrowing $680 million to build, repair, expand, and equip Wake County public-school buildings.

YES: Allow this borrowing, plus interest, and property taxes needed to repay it.

NO: Do not allow this particular bond plan. Other school-funding decisions can still happen.

Better buildings could help children learn safely. Borrowing also means future payments. Even if you learn at home, your friends and neighbors may use these schools, and the costs affect the community.

Grown-up numbers: $680 million borrowed; estimated lifetime interest $363,387,458. Ballot tax estimate: $4.10 a year per $100,000 of property-tax value. Estimates are not guarantees or caps.

TALK ABOUT THE TRADEOFF

When does fixing something now help enough to make borrowing worthwhile?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02. See the back of the book.

Building places for bigger learners

Wake County Community College Bonds

Learning keeps going after childhood. At Wake Tech, people can study for jobs, learn new skills, or begin a college education.

This question asks about borrowing $149.1 million to build, repair, expand, and equip Wake Technical Community College facilities.

YES: Allow this borrowing, plus interest, and property taxes needed to repay it.

NO: Do not allow this particular bond plan. Other ways to fund Wake Tech remain possible.

The buildings could help train people our community needs, such as nurses and skilled workers. The county would also owe future payments. A useful building still has a cost.

Grown-up numbers: $149.1 million borrowed; estimated lifetime interest $79,667,016. Ballot tax estimate: $0.90 a year per $100,000 of property-tax value. Estimates are not guarantees or caps.

TALK ABOUT THE TRADEOFF

What is a skill you would love to learn when you are older?

Grown-up sources: 01, 02. See the back of the book.

Small person. Good questions.

You do not have to pick a candidate to be a good learner. You can practice noticing what a community needs.

1. Notice

Draw one thing in our community that helps people.

2. Wonder

Which job in this book could help care for it?

3. Ask

What would you ask a person who wants that job?

Read, pause, and follow the evidence.

Purpose and scope

A nonpartisan read-aloud adaptation of the linked guide, covering all 14 candidate contests, all 36 printed candidates, the permitted write-in lines, and all five measures on sample ballot B0037. It is not an official ballot or a recommendation. It does not cover races on other Wake County ballot styles.

Using it with a six-year-old

Read one spread per sitting. The AI-assisted illustrations show invented civic scenes, not actual candidates or exact places. Big ideas are simplified for listening; names and office labels remain exact. Let your child ask questions without needing to choose a side.

What the candidate cards mean

Biographies draw from the October 11 guide and the cited records. "Says" summarizes a candidate's own priorities, not verified results. The same neutral design is used for every candidate. Judicial statements describe an approach to judging, not a promise about a future case.

What this review can and cannot establish

Sources were consulted October 29, 2026. This adds current stated priorities to the original guide; it is not an exhaustive audit of votes, finances, performance, or conduct. No note about a candidate should be read as proof of a clean record. The next two pages preserve important context from the original guide.

Printing

Use U.S. Letter paper, portrait, at 100% or "actual size." Print double-sided and flip on the long edge. Keep page 1 as the cover so even-numbered job pages face odd-numbered candidate pages. This is a normal page-order PDF, not an imposed fold-and-staple booklet. Color brings the paintings to life; the text also stays legible in grayscale.

Important context

Deborah K. Ross / disclosure timing

An official transaction report signed May 14, 2023 lists a November 7, 2022 merger-related exchange of her spouse's Ironsource shares for Unity shares, valued at $1,001-$15,000, with notification November 30. Compared with House reporting deadlines, these dates appear late. That is an inference from a document, not an adjudicated violation. The original guide found no formal ruling, response, or verified earlier filing. This does not establish insider trading or corruption.

Sources: 39, 45, 02

Anita Earls / complaint dismissed

The judicial-standards complaint about her public comments concerning bias was dismissed in January 2024. She then ended her related federal lawsuit. This complaint did not produce judicial discipline. A dismissed complaint should not be described as a finding of misconduct.

Sources: 44, 02

Sarah Stevens / campaign contributions

January 2026 reporting describes an elections-board warning concerning two lobbyist contributions totaling $6,800, which Stevens returned. Investigators reported insufficient evidence of an intentional violation. This was not a criminal finding.

Sources: 41, 02

George Cooper Bell / lawyer discipline

A February 14, 2020 Tennessee Supreme Court order publicly censured Bell in reciprocal discipline based on an August 7, 2019 North Carolina State Bar public reprimand. These are formal professional actions. The original guide describes the underlying matter as a misleading representation about a client's probation status; that underlying NC journal link was unavailable during this review. The official Tennessee order verifies the discipline, not the full underlying factual account. It concerns conduct as a lawyer, rather than a review of his judicial decisions.

Sources: 40, 02

Safety, trust, and limits.

Kenny Blackwell / unresolved residency questions

ABC11 reported August 28, 2026 that Blackwell owned a Franklin County home and was registered at a Wake County home owned by his wife. He said he split his time, complied with the law, and planned to move fully to Wake County at least a month before the election. The report said no candidate challenge, protest, or investigation was then pending. This is a reported residency question, not a finding of ineligibility. This review did not establish a later adjudication.

Sources: 42

Willie Rowe / jail supervision failures

Reporting on state records found that staff missed required supervision before Blair Medford's February 2024 death at the county jail. Three detention officers were fired. The office described retraining, audits, and body cameras as corrective steps. Rowe said the office takes the safety of people in custody seriously. The original guide says a corrective plan was accepted; this review has not independently measured whether the changes prevent similar failures. The finding concerns failures in the office he leads; it is not a finding that Rowe personally caused the death.

Sources: 43, 02

Ballot-measure numbers and uncertainty

The school bond's disclosed estimated lifetime total is $1,043,387,458; the Wake Tech bond's is $228,767,016. Each includes principal and estimated interest. The ballot uses the highest rate for similar debt in the prior 20 years to estimate costs. Annual tax estimates of $4.10 and $0.90 per $100,000 are not fixed bills or tax ceilings. The bond orders authorize property taxes sufficient for repayment. The tax-cap questions set constraints or require future laws; they do not promise a particular household's savings.

Sources: 01, 37, 38

Where we looked

Numbers on the story pages point here. Campaign and questionnaire material states what candidates say. Government records and reporting have different roles.

01 / Official sample ballot B0037

Official election document

https://s3.amazonaws.com/ncsbesb/20261103/1429_92_B0037.pdf

02 / Original Wake County voter guide

Family guide; researched October 11, 2026

https://wake-voter-guide-2026.moth.chatgpt.site

03 / U.S. Senate: powers and procedures

Official explanation

https://www.senate.gov/about/powers-procedures.htm

04 / The U.S. House explained

Official explanation

https://www.house.gov/the-house-explained

05 / North Carolina court officials

Official explanation

https://www.nccourts.gov/learn/court-officials

06 / 2026 judicial voter guide

Official guide; candidate-written submissions

https://www.ncsbe.gov/voting/upcoming-election/judicial-voter-guide-2026-general-election

07 / North Carolina General Assembly overview

Official explanation

https://www.ncleg.gov/Help/Topic/27

08 / Soil and water district responsibilities

Official fact sheet, linked in original guide

https://www.ncagr.gov/soil-water/swcdistrict-fact-sheet/download?attachment=

Where we looked

Numbers on the story pages point here. Campaign and questionnaire material states what candidates say. Government records and reporting have different roles.

09 / Michael Dublin: biography

Candidate statement

https://www.dublinforcongress.com/about

10 / 2026 U.S. Senate candidate questionnaire

News & Observer questionnaire, October 10, 2026; candidates answer

https://www.aol.com/articles/asked-four-candidates-nc-senate-174212000.html

11 / Michael Whatley: priorities

Candidate statement

https://michaelwhatley.com/

12 / 2026 U.S. House District 2 questionnaire

News & Observer questionnaire, October 7, 2026; candidates answer

https://www.aol.com/articles/raleigh-lawmaker-wants-hold-trump-210452000.html

13 / Deborah Ross: education

Official congressional priorities

https://ross.house.gov/education

14 / Haseeb Fatmi: questionnaire

INDY questionnaire, updated October 22, 2026; candidate answers

https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/senate-district-18-haseeb-fatmi-2026/

15 / Chris Stock: plan

Candidate statement

https://www.stockfornc.com/

16 / Brad Hessel: priorities

Candidate statement

https://electbradhessel.org/

Where we looked

Numbers on the story pages point here. Campaign and questionnaire material states what candidates say. Government records and reporting have different roles.

17 / Mike Schietzelt: priorities
Candidate statement
https://mikeschietzelt.com/

18 / Evonne Hopkins: priorities and biography
Candidate statement
https://www.hopkinsforhouse.com/

19 / Rashad Hauter: approach and experience
Candidate statement
https://www.judgehauter.com/

20 / Wiley Nickel: district attorney priorities
Candidate statement
https://www.wileynickel.com/issues/

21 / Kyle Stogoski: questionnaire
INDY questionnaire; candidate answers
https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/wake-board-of-county-commissioners-at-large-kyle-stogoski-2026/

22 / Mona Singh: questionnaire
INDY questionnaire; candidate answers
https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/wake-board-of-county-commissioners-at-large-mona-singh-2026/

23 / Christine Kushner: questionnaire
INDY questionnaire; candidate answers
https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/wake-board-of-county-commissioners-at-large-christine-kushner-2026/

24 / Gary Hartong: priorities
Candidate statement
https://www.garyforwake.org/

Where we looked

Numbers on the story pages point here. Campaign and questionnaire material states what candidates say. Government records and reporting have different roles.

25 / Claudia Croom: questionnaire

INDY questionnaire, October 8, 2026; candidate answers

https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/wake-county-clerk-of-superior-court-claudia-croom-2026/

26 / Joe Teague Jr.: approach

Candidate statement

https://www.joeteaguejrforclerkofcourt.com/

27 / Kenny Blackwell: priorities

Candidate statement

https://kenny4wake.com/

28 / Willie Rowe: priorities

Candidate statement

https://www.roweforsheriff.com/

29 / Beth Pugh Farrell: questionnaire

INDY questionnaire, October 8-9, 2026; candidate answers

https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/wake-county-soil-and-water-conservation-district-board-of-supervisors-beth-pugh-farrell-2026/

30 / Jim White: conservation approach

Candidate statement

https://jimwhite4wake.com/

31 / Terence Thomas: questionnaire

INDY questionnaire, October 8-9, 2026; candidate answers

https://indyweek.com/news/politics/elections/wake-county-soil-and-water-conservation-district-board-of-supervisors-terence-thomas-2026/

32 / Brian K. Lewis: conservation approach

Candidate statement

https://lewisfornc.org/

Where we looked

Numbers on the story pages point here. Campaign and questionnaire material states what candidates say. Government records and reporting have different roles.

33 / Samantha Krop: priorities

Candidate statement

https://www.krop4wake.com/priorities

34 / Cece Grant: biography and priorities

Candidate statement

https://cece4wake.com/

35 / Photo ID amendment: Session Law 2024-58

Official amendment text

https://www.ncleg.gov/EnactedLegislation/SessionLaws/HTML/2023-2024/SL2024-58.html

36 / Current voter ID rules and exceptions

Official election guidance

https://www.ncsbe.gov/voting/voter-id

37 / Income-tax cap: Session Law 2026-4

Official amendment text

https://www.ncleg.gov/EnactedLegislation/SessionLaws/HTML/2025-2026/SL2026-4.html

38 / Property-tax limits: Session Law 2026-5

Official amendment text

https://www.ncleg.gov/EnactedLegislation/SessionLaws/HTML/2025-2026/SL2026-5.html

39 / Ross: transaction report, signed May 14, 2023

Official disclosure; does not itself establish a violation

https://disclosures-clerk.house.gov/public_disc/ptr-pdfs/2023/20022808.pdf

40 / Bell: Tennessee reciprocal discipline order

Official order, February 14, 2020; cites 2019 NC reprimand

https://docs.tbpr.org/bell-3045.pdf

Where we looked

Numbers on the story pages point here. Campaign and questionnaire material states what candidates say. Government records and reporting have different roles.

41 / Stevens: campaign-contribution warning

News & Observer reporting, January 13, 2026

https://www.newsobserver.com/news/politics-government/article314304398.html

42 / Blackwell: residency questions and his response

ABC11 reporting, August 28, 2026; no finding of ineligibility

https://abc11.com/post/kenny-blackwell-team-looks-wake-county-sheriff-candidate-lives-full-time/19753442/

43 / Rowe: jail supervision failures and response

News & Observer reporting, updated June 30, 2025

https://www.newsobserver.com/news/politics-government/article308941270.html

44 / Earls: complaint dismissed

AP reporting via WUNC, January 17, 2024

https://www.wunc.org/politics/2024-01-17/north-carolina-justice-ends-suit-against-ethics-panel-after-it-dismisses-complaint

45 / House financial-disclosure deadlines

Official ethics guidance, linked in original guide

https://ethics.house.gov/periodic-transaction-report-calculator/

46 / Wake commissioner terms: Session Law 2023-30

Official law; top at-large vote-getter serves 4 years, second serves 2 in 2026

https://www.ncleg.gov/EnactedLegislation/SessionLaws/HTML/2023-2024/SL2023-30.html

A community is made of us.

People do different jobs.

They bring different ideas.

We can ask careful questions.

We can care about our neighbors.

Keep wondering.

Something I want to ask next...